

REU Student Orientation

These slides are on our [GitHub page](#).

Welcome!

CIERA REU Leadership:

Cliff Johnson

Research Faculty & REU Director

Megan Newsome

UT Austin Postdoc & Co-director

Day 1 (Monday, June 23)

- 9:30-10:00: Meet and Greet
- 10:00-11:00: Rubin First Look Event!
- 11:00-12:00: Orientation
- 12:00-2:00: Campus tour + lunch (you bring/buy)
- 2-5pm: Meet with mentor(s)
- 5:30pm: Dinner (CIERA buys)
 - Meet in 8th Floor Sky Lounge at ~5:00pm

Intro Activity

**Partner Intros:
Basics &
Mundane Superpower**

Mentors & Projects

Student	Research Mentor(s)
Elaine Bai (any)	Miller
Maddy Evenson (she/her)	Strom & Miller
Aidan Groenendaal (he/him)	Shahriar
Srishti Gupta (they/them)	vanderLee
Isabel Lockhart (she/her)	Wang
Via Lucal (they/she)	Lithwick
Jorie McDermott (she/her)	Kalogera & Chattopadhyay
Shirsha Mukherjee (he/him)	Kalogera & Ray
Sora Norris (he/him)	Tchekhovskoy
Tristan Parmerlee (he/him)	Rasio
Aidan Rodts (he/him)	Novak
Sam Tello (he/him)	deGouvea
Aster Winkler (they/them or he/him)	Starkenber

Our Role: We're Here for You!

Cliff Johnson & Megan Newsome

- Support positive mentor-mentee relationships
 - “Open door” policy for both mentors & mentees
 - Confidentiality
- IT support / Logistics / Admin
- Megan running most of the workshops
- Cliff Office Hours: 7425, Thursday 3:00-4:00pm
 - Also by appointment!
- REU Group Meeting: 7-600, Friday 3:30-4:30pm

Logistics

- Dates: June 23 - August 22 (9 weeks)
- Office(s) : 1800 Sherman 8th floor
- Workshops: 1800 Sherman 7th floor 7-600
- Mentors in 1800 Sherman 7th + 8th floor or Tech
- Slack + Email (+ Zoom)
- Provided:
 - ID Card + NetID + Quest Accounts (+ laptops)
 - Stipends + dorm housing + dining Cat Cash

Note: Lost electronic key = \$25, lost physical key = \$250, lock-out = \$10 (we will cover this within reason)

Logistics

Stipends

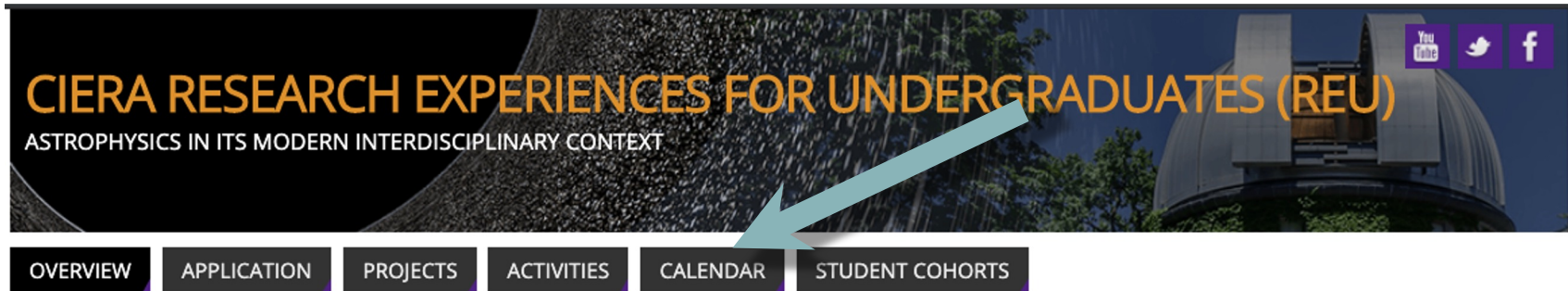
- Set up Direct Deposit via myHR (due today!)
- Treated as scholarship: No W2 from Northwestern

Cat Cash on Housing Cards

- \$800 initial balance, can increase later
- 2 meals, 5 days: $\$12.99 + \$19.49 = \$32.48/\text{day}$, $162.40/\text{week}$
- Sargent Dining Hall (2245 Sheridan Rd) – Hours: 7am-9am, 11am-1:30pm, 5pm-7pm – Menu: dineoncampus.com/northwestern
- Other Venues: Norris (lunch today!)

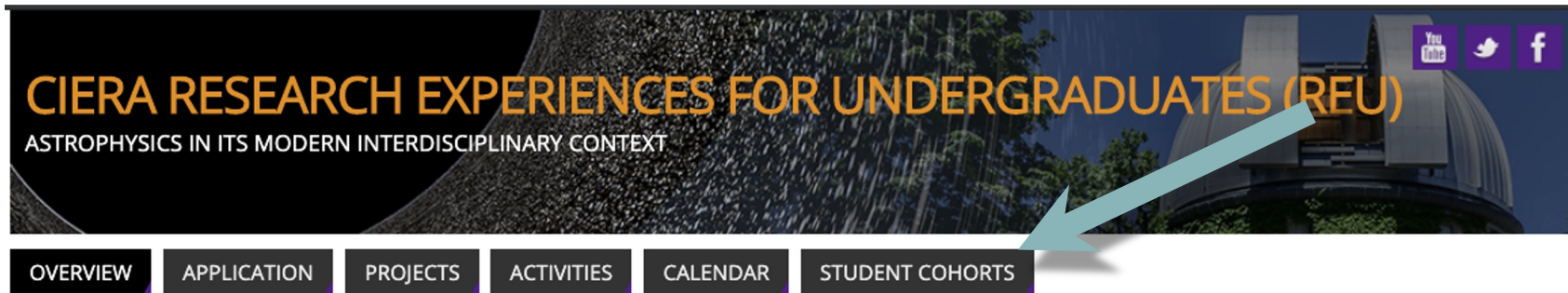
Professional Development

- Python programming workshops
- Quest, GitHub, command line, website tutorials
- RCTP science communication workshops
- Writing workshops
- Research seminars by NU researchers
- Grad school & Career Panel Discussions
- SkAI Open House



Final Products

- Poster to present at January AAS meeting
 - “Experts” poster session in person (August 21)
 - “General” poster session on Zoom (August 22)
- Draft journal article (project summary) in RNAAS style
- Research website, GitHub repo(s)
- Keep working with your advisor(s) remotely!



Community/Team Building

June 23 : REU Group Dinner

June 27 : Lakefill BBQ with Summer Colleagues

July 12 : Field trip to the Adler Planetarium

July 23 : Field trip to Fermilab

August 2 : Field trip to the Yerkes Observatory

Also check here:

<https://www.northwestern.edu/norris/arts-and-recreation/summer-at-norris/index.html>

Day 1 (Monday, June 23)

In your meeting with your mentor, remember to ask (at least) 5 of these questions (see Slack):

1. How did you get started in research?
2. What is some advice you got that has really stayed with you? Do you have a story of a time when it was applicable and influenced what you did or wished you had done?
3. What hobbies do you have? Do you have one you really miss? Is there one you still make regular time for?
4. What is a food that you really like? Why?
5. Would you tell me about a time when you did not succeed the way that you wanted to? What did you do or wish you had done then? What did you learn from that experience, and how has it shaped what you have done since?
6. What have your past students gone on to do career-wise?
7. What kinds of questions should I come to ask you vs. asking others in your group? How would you let me know if you think I'm asking a question you're not prepared to answer?
8. How do you handle things when something difficult or stressful has happened personally that causes you not to be able to focus? How might you let me know so I can be helpful and work well with you?
9. What are some of the other demands on your time this summer? How often would you like us to meet to talk? What do you expect that we will talk about when we meet?

Communication Options

Ask your mentor(s) their preferred form of communication.

We will use the following:

- **Slack**
 - Quick response time, short entries
 - Cohort channel
- **Email**
 - Longer wait time, but more permanent
 - Easier to search
- **Zoom + in-person**
 - Meetings, office hours, etc.

Communication Options

Slack Use: Channels

- #reu2025
- #announcements
- DMs

Code of Conduct

Our Code of Conduct:

https://github.com/CIERA-Northwestern/CIERA_REU/blob/main/code_of_conduct.pdf

Values:

Shared Responsibility, Honesty, Respect

Principles of Engagement:

raise all voices

no: feigning surprise, “well-actually”s, -isms

If you see or experience problematic behaviors: consider raising the issue in the moment, but you can also raise with REU leadership

If you err: apologize, reflect how you can learn, move on

Reporting: speak to or email Cliff, Megan, Kari Frank (CIERA Director of Operations).
Also available: NU Title IX office, NU Office of the Ombudsperson

Research Project Best Practices

- Communicating with your Mentor(s)
- Optimizing Your Progress
- Developing Independence

See: https://github.com/CIERA-Northwestern/CIERA_REU/blob/main/orientation/student_best_practices.pdf

Self Care

Actively take care of your body and mind!

- Sleep well and enough
- Exercise (even just going for a walk)
- Keep up with personal hygiene
- Set a schedule and stick to it
- Set realistic goals for yourself
- Schedule non-work activities
- Talk with your cohort about things other than work
- Be kind to yourself

Let's go see your office space!

